

June

9



Balancing act

1815

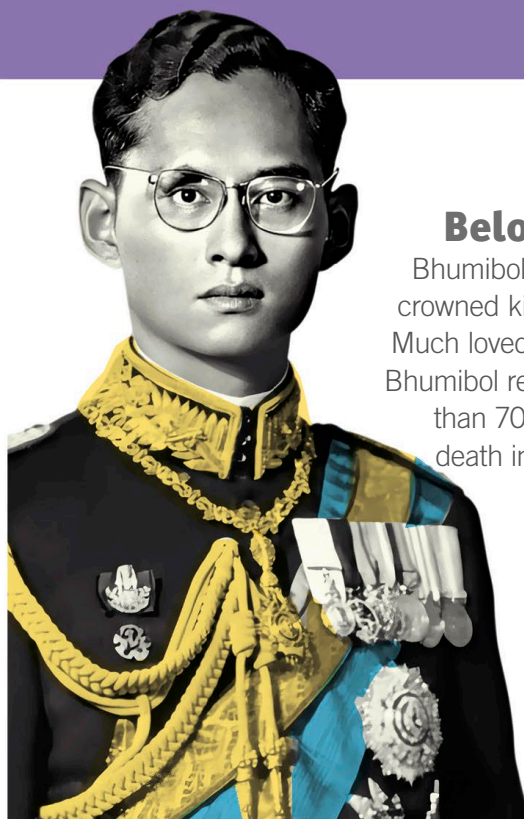
The Congress of Vienna, a conference to discuss how to ensure lasting peace in Europe after the defeat of French emperor Napoleon Bonaparte, came to a close. Ambassadors agreed to reorganize some national borders in the hope of keeping power balanced between nations.

Also on this day

1898 China was forced to lease Hong Kong's New Territories rent-free to the UK for a period of 99 years.

1909 The first woman to drive across the USA from coast to coast, Alice Huyler Ramsey set off in her car from New York City.

1934 Disney's Donald Duck made his first appearance in the animated short film *The Wise Little Hen*.



1946

Beloved ruler

Bhumibol Adulyadej was crowned king of Thailand. Much loved by his people, Bhumibol reigned for more than 70 years, until his death in 2016, making him one of the longest-serving monarchs in history.

Born this day

1981 Natalie Portman, Israeli-born US actor and filmmaker. A star of many blockbuster movies, she won the Best Actress Oscar for her performance in *Black Swan*.



1534 A passage to Asia

On a voyage to the northern lands of North America in search of gold, spices, and a new route from Europe to Asia, French navigator Jacques Cartier reached the Saint Lawrence River. He became the first European explorer to map the region.